

Research Proposal (First Draft)

AIBS — AI adoption in equipment servicing for Koffiebranderij Peeze

1. Target audience

Koffiebranderij Peeze, a coffee roaster headquartered in Arnhem with roots going back to 1879, roughly 50 to 60 employees. Historically family-run; in May 2025 it was acquired by Coffee Growth Group, an alliance backed by investor Berk Partners that also owns Mocca d'Or, Santas Koffie, Café del Mar and EARTH Coffee. Peeze continues to operate under its own name and management.

Beyond roasting and packaging coffee, Peeze runs a B2B “total solution” business: supplying, leasing and maintaining hot-beverage equipment for hospitality and office clients, and is the Dutch importer for Dalla Corte espresso machines. The company markets itself heavily on sustainability: Fairtrade and climate-neutral coffee lines, and a circular, reusable-packaging pilot run with FMO and Burgers' Zoo.

Working decision: whether AI-based predictive maintenance for the machines Peeze leases and services could reduce reactive, emergency dispatch costs, and whether that is realistic for a company this size to run without a dedicated IT or data function, especially now that it sits inside a larger investor-backed group. This is a hypothesis to confirm or revise once the team has actually talked to Peeze, not an established fact.

2. What they need

Per Draghi's diagnosis, Peeze sits in the exact gap the report describes: not too small to have digital ambitions, not large enough to have in-house AI capability. What they most likely need: a plain read on whether predictive maintenance tools are mature enough for a company their size to run without hiring anyone new, a realistic view of what it costs to find out, and clarity on whether adopting one is even Peeze's decision to make alone now that Coffee Growth Group is involved, or whether it happens at group level. That governance question deserves its own line of research rather than being assumed away.

3. Research question

Main question: What does workable AI adoption look like for Koffiebranderij Peeze around its equipment-service business, and what would it take to move from reactive to more predictive maintenance without new headcount or infrastructure?

External (context, market, risk)

- Which AI-enabled maintenance or monitoring tools are realistically accessible to a company Peeze's size, and what do they cost to trial?
- What are comparable Dutch coffee roasters or hospitality-equipment suppliers already doing with AI, if anything?

Internal (situation, capabilities, decision-making)

- Where do Peeze's service costs and customer complaints actually concentrate today, and does predictive maintenance address that or something else?
- Now that Peeze is part of Coffee Growth Group, is a decision like this made locally at Peeze or centrally, and what does that mean for a pilot's timeline and budget?

4. Quality criteria for the handbook

- Answers a decision Peeze, or a comparable-sized equipment-service SME, can actually act on, not a general AI overview
- Honest about vendor lock-in and cost, not just capability
- At least one grounded, numbers-based example rather than only concepts
- Written for someone without a data background
- Doesn't assert facts about Peeze the team hasn't confirmed; flags anything still unverified

5. Methodology

Desk research: Dutch coffee and hospitality trade press, KvK and CBS data on the sector, and what's publicly known about Coffee Growth Group's other brands. Serves the external sub-questions.

Field research: one visit to Peeze arranged through the HAN partnership, to interview an operations or service lead on what maintenance looks like today, where it breaks down, and who would actually decide on a pilot. Serves the internal sub-questions.